

Colors in the sky

The sky isn't always blue, even when it's clear. Near sunset it can be purple or even red. This is because sunlight is made up of the seven colors of the rainbow, all mixed up together. As sunlight bounces in different ways off dust and other particles in the air, different colors appear.



Rainbow Snake

Australian Aboriginals worship a spirit known as the Rainbow Snake. He lives in water and is the great creator who has made the features of the Earth. He can appear as a rainbow.

Rainbows are curved because of the way light hits the round raindrops.



Curving colors

When sunlight passes through raindrops in the air, the light splits into seven colors—red, orange, yellow, green, blue, indigo, and violet. Many raindrops help to create the pattern.